

BlueRay discs, and certain additional functionalities such as the ability to add watermarks, and WatchFolder, a nifty little app that resides in your taskbar and automatically transcodes all the videos added or downloaded to a particular folder.

Basic tasks with Handbrake

Say you have attended a panel discussion at a conference, and have recorded a video of the whole event, and now want to publish it on the web. Distributing such a video might require you to add subtitles, closed captions and multiple audio tracks (let's just say we live in an ideal world where everyone has a lot of free time, and is seriously interested in the dissemination of information, and you are meticulous enough to provide voice translation services for the speakers in multiple languages), you can do all of that through Handbrake. If you choose to add subtitles, you can even burn them in, or make them part of the video, but Handbrake very reasonably and sensibly does not allow you to burn in subtitles in multiple languages onto the same video. You can also release the video in multiple resolutions, to be considerate towards those who are willing to use up their bandwidth to download a 1080p video, or are willing to watch this interesting panel discussion in only a 720p resolution. Additionally, you can include chapter markers into the video, so that users can quickly navigate to answers to particular questions asked during the course of the panel discussion, and don't have to waste their time watching other stuff that may not be relevant to them. If you have recorded the audio information from each speaker separately, you can get a professional mixer to create a surround sound mix of the discussion, and preserve that information in the video encoded by Handbrake. Basically, Handbrake is the best software to use if you want to distribute videos of panel discussions from conferences. If there are videos from other sources, with say black bars on the top and bottom, then Handbrake has another brilliant feature up its sleeve, it will save hard disk space by automatically cropping out the black bars, and saving only the video portion of the... video.

Transcoding a video

This is one of the simplest and most basic functionalities of Handbrake. First open a single video file. Now, have a look at the settings. There are only a few container options available (file format), but these are the best ones. The options are mp4, mkv and webm. Under Presets, is where all the magic